

FIGURE 4.1 In the park, 1984. (V/N-47/227, Audre Lorde Archive, John-F.-Kennedy-Institut für Nordamerikastudien, Freie Universität Berlin Archives)

After she returned to the United States in July 1984, her health remained stable for several months. She began publishing numerous poems, essays, and journal entries drafted during, related to, and inspired by her time in Berlin. The imprint of Lorde's first trip to Berlin, including her three-month guest professorship at the Kennedy Institute for North American Studies at the Free University, would become most publicly legible to readers of *Our Dead Behind Us* (1986)—a collection of poems that includes "Berlin Is Hard on Colored Girls," "This Urn Contains Earth from German Concentration Camps: Plotzensee Memorial, West Berlin, 1984," and "Diaspora"—as well